

Accessibility Palette Sheets



Companion to the Branding Style Sheet: the institute's palette re-issued for each condition it serves. Each sheet is labeled by the condition it responds to, and every value is computed against WCAG 2.1, not estimated.

Owner: Branding & Outreach

THE BASE PALETTE THESE SHEETS ADAPT

The settled assignments. Divisions first, Bridge Groups second. Every sheet that follows starts from these values and changes only what the named condition requires.

HOME	COLOR	HEX
Research	 Inquiry Sienna	#B34E2B
Technology, AI & Information Systems	 Interface Blue	#075AA6
Experience Architecture	 Embodied Teal	#154D5C
Lumina Lingua	 Meaning Violet	#8A79A9
The Light School	 Growth Amber	#D2A35E
Community Service	 Service Green	#8A9D68
Governance	 Stewardship Olive	#496129
Finance & Fundraising	 Foundation Teal	#366067
Internal Communications	 Radiant Violet	#60508D
Branding & Outreach	 Beacon Brick	#8F4239

SHEET 1 · LOW VISION AND CONTRAST SENSITIVITY

Condition responded to: reduced visual acuity and contrast sensitivity, including age-related change, cataract, and partial sight. What helps is not different hues but stronger separation between figure and ground. WCAG AA requires 4.5:1 for body-size text; seven of the ten base colors already pass on the ivory ground, and three do not. Colored text therefore carries a narrow outline in the opposite ground color: Midnight Blue on Ivory Tint, Ivory Tint on Midnight Blue. WCAG 2.1 treats a narrow border around the letter as part of the letter, so contrast is measured from the outline, 16.15:1 on either ground. The base color remains the brand color everywhere else.

HOME	BASE VS IVORY	STATUS
Research	4.85 : 1	passes as is
Technology, AI & Info. Systems	6.48 : 1	passes as is
Experience Architecture	8.72 : 1	passes as is
Lumina Lingua	3.64 : 1	outline required for text
The Light School	2.14 : 1	outline required for text
Community Service	2.76 : 1	outline required for text
Governance	6.48 : 1	passes as is
Finance & Fundraising	6.48 : 1	passes as is
Internal Communications	6.47 : 1	passes as is
Branding & Outreach	6.52 : 1	passes as is

Growth Amber (The Light School) at 2.14:1 and Service Green (Community Service) at 2.76:1 are the lightest base colors; any text in them carries the Midnight outline. Luminara Gold #F4BE3B measures 1.60:1 against ivory and never carries text on light grounds; on Midnight it measures 10.12:1 and shines. Document ink #111a4a runs 15.42:1 on ivory.

ON DARK GROUNDS

The same eyes need the same separation on Midnight Blue #030F58 and video grounds, where the base colors run too deep. Each color lifts toward white by eighteen percent; the 3:1 large-text threshold is computed against Midnight. Body text on dark grounds is always Ivory, never a division color; these serve headings, icons, chips, and lower thirds, and colored headings carry the narrow Ivory Tint outline.

HOME	DARK-GROUND HEX	VS MIDNIGHT	LARGE-TEXT AA (3:1)
Research	 #C16E51	4.63 : 1	passes
Technology, AI & Info. Systems	 #3478B6	3.72 : 1	passes
Experience Architecture	 #3F6D79	3.03 : 1	passes, barely; prefer icon use over type
Lumina Lingua	 #9F91B8	5.95 : 1	passes
The Light School	 #DAB47B	8.90 : 1	passes
Community Service	 #9FAF83	7.36 : 1	passes
Governance	 #6A7D50	3.84 : 1	passes
Finance & Fundraising	 #5A7D82	3.87 : 1	passes
Internal Communications	 #7D70A2	3.88 : 1	passes
Branding & Outreach	 #A3645D	3.74 : 1	passes

SHEET 2 • RED-GREEN COLOR VISION DEFICIENCY

Condition responded to: deuteranopia and deuteranomaly (green cone absent or shifted) and protanopia and protanomaly (red cone absent or shifted), together the most common forms: roughly eight percent of men and half a percent of women. Red-green hue distinctions collapse; what survives is luminance, the lightness channel. A pair is safe when its lightness separation is large; it is risky when two hues differ mainly in redness or greenness at similar lightness. The closest pairs under simulated red-green vision, worse of protan and deutan:

PAIR		SIMULATED ΔE	PAIR CONTRAST	READING
 Inquiry Sienna	 Stewardship Olive	1.8	1.34 : 1	same swatch under red-green vision
 Stewardship Olive	 Beacon Brick	3.8	1.01 : 1	same swatch; identical lightness
 Embodied Teal	 Foundation Teal	9.3	1.35 : 1	same swatch; close in normal vision too
 Interface Blue	 Radiant Violet	11.7	1.00 : 1	close; identical lightness
 Growth Amber	 Service Green	14.3	1.29 : 1	close; rely on labels
 Meaning Violet	 Radiant Violet	17.6	1.78 : 1	close; rely on labels

The response. Distances are CIELAB ΔE after the Machado, Oliveira & Fernandes (2009) simulation at full severity: below about 10 two colors read as the same swatch, and 20 or more is comfortable. Three pairs fall below 10, each joining a division to a Bridge Group or two Bridge Groups: Inquiry Sienna (Research) with Stewardship Olive (Governance), Stewardship Olive with Beacon Brick (Branding & Outreach), and Embodied Teal (Experience Architecture) with Foundation Teal (Finance & Fundraising). No chart accent is issued; wherever these pairs appear together, the governing rule on the last sheet applies and every element carries its label.

SHEET 3 • BLUE-YELLOW COLOR VISION DEFICIENCY

Condition responded to: tritanopia and tritanomaly (blue cone absent or shifted), the rare form: on the order of one in ten thousand, affecting men and women equally. Blue-yellow distinctions collapse; blues, teals, and violets draw together, as do yellows and warm midtones. The closest pairs under simulated tritan vision:

PAIR		SIMULATED ΔE	PAIR CONTRAST	READING
 Embodied Teal	 Foundation Teal	7.2	1.35 : 1	same swatch under tritan vision
 Interface Blue	 Foundation Teal	8.9	1.00 : 1	same swatch; identical lightness
 Interface Blue	 Embodied Teal	13.0	1.34 : 1	close; rely on labels
 Stewardship Olive	 Radiant Violet	14.2	1.00 : 1	close; identical lightness
 Meaning Violet	 Service Green	14.2	1.32 : 1	close; rely on labels
 Stewardship Olive	 Foundation Teal	14.9	1.00 : 1	close; identical lightness

The response. Two pairs fall below 10, both joining Foundation Teal (Finance & Fundraising) to a blue or teal division: Embodied Teal (Experience Architecture) and Interface Blue (Technology). As on Sheet 2, the separation comes from labels, not from a chart accent; the governing rule on the last sheet carries it.

SHEET 4 • COMPLETE COLOR BLINDNESS

Condition responded to: achromatopsia, the absence of color perception: roughly one in thirty thousand people, who see the palette as pure luminance. This sheet shows the gray each color actually presents. Where two grays match, those colors are indistinguishable, and only position, label, shape, or pattern separates them.

HOME	COLOR	PRESENTS AS	GRAY
The Light School	 Growth Amber	 #ABABAB	lightest
Community Service	 Service Green	 #969696	light
Lumina Lingua	 Meaning Violet	 #818181	light-mid
Research	 Inquiry Sienna	 #6D6D6D	mid
Internal Communications	 Radiant Violet	 #5A5A5A	merged band
Finance & Fundraising	 Foundation Teal	 #5A5A5A	merged band
Governance	 Stewardship Olive	 #5A5A5A	merged band
Technology, AI & Info. Systems	 Interface Blue	 #5A5A5A	merged band
Branding & Outreach	 Beacon Brick	 #595959	merged band
Experience Architecture	 Embodied Teal	 #474747	darkest

The response. Five of the ten colors land in one merged gray band (#595959 to #5A5A5A): to an achromatic reader, Technology and all four Bridge Groups are the same color. No palette that keeps these brand hues can fix that in gray; the fix is structural and already adopted as the governing rule: every color-coded element carries its label, and printed materials stay legible photocopied in black and white, which is also the test any staff member can run without tools.

SHEET 5 · PHOTSENSITIVITY AND VISUAL STRESS

Condition responded to: light sensitivity and pattern-related visual stress, including migraine and post-concussion sensitivity. What helps is a softened ground, reduced saturation over large areas, and no high-frequency contrast patterns. The document ivory #FBF7EA already sits below pure white; for large fields, the palette softens to these tints, blended three quarters of the way toward ivory. Tints are grounds only; they never carry meaning alone and never carry text without an ink-dark foreground.

HOME	SOFT TINT	INTENDED USE
Research	 #E9CDBA	Section tint
Technology, AI & Info. Systems	 #BED0D9	Section tint
Experience Architecture	 #C2CDC7	Section tint
Lumina Lingua	 #DFD8DA	Section tint
The Light School	 #F1E2C7	Section tint
Community Service	 #DFE1CA	Section tint
Governance	 #CFD2BA	Row shading
Finance & Fundraising	 #CAD1C9	Row shading
Internal Communications	 #D4CDD3	Row shading
Branding & Outreach	 #E0CABE	Row shading

Full-saturation Luminara Gold stays an accent at this sheet's sizes, never a full-page ground; animated or flashing brand elements are not used in any material, on any surface.

THE GOVERNING RULE: NEVER COLOR ALONE

Any meaning a color carries is also carried by a word, shape, or pattern. This rule governs every sheet above. Accessibility in this system is achieved first by labeling and iconography, and only second by the luminance engineering on these sheets; no chart, map, badge, or document in the institute's materials may rely on hue as the sole carrier of information. This is the accessibility floor beneath the palette, adopted alongside the every-page identity rule. Colored text on Ivory Tint carries a narrow Midnight Blue outline; on Midnight Blue, a narrow Ivory Tint outline.

Prevalence figures follow published vision-science reporting. Contrast values and gray equivalents are computed from the hex values by WCAG 2.1 relative luminance; pair distances on Sheets 2 and 3 are CIELAB ΔE after the Machado, Oliveira & Fernandes (2009) simulation. Color names pair each home's theme word with its color family.